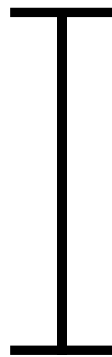




▲ PORT OF CALL

The government is planning to launch a shipbuilding and repair policy to ensure that the growing demand for it is met in Indian shipyards



INDIA'S COASTS HAVE seen many eras when commerce and culture have blossomed over millennia. But maritime freight movement has dropped in recent years, even though this is the cheapest mode of transportation.

Aware of the vast potential here, the Union government has highlighted the blue economy as one of the 10 core motors of economic growth in its 'Vision 2030' document. There is also the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, a subsidiary of the Amrit Kaal Vision 2047, that focusses on enhancing ports' capacity and promoting inland water transport and coastal shipping with a proposed investment of ₹80 lakh crore.

By channelling technology, digitisation, and renewable energy, the government is looking to give ports a facelift and make them safe, smart, secure, and sustainable. There are proposals to increase the capacity of existing ports, develop new ones and maritime clusters, and enhance the efficiency of ports with the incorporation of the latest technology.

Through these measures, the government hopes to improve multi-modal connectivity at the ports and subsequently improve the modal share of coastal shipping and inland waterways.

THE VISION



The Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 pegs the total investment opportunity at ₹80 lakh crore over the next 25 years



It aims to create four port clusters with capacity equal to or more than 300 MTPA, and two with capacity of 500 MTPA or more



Setting up transshipment hubs at Vizhinjam and Galathea Bay, both with 20 metre deep draft



Targets increasing India's share of transshipment cargo to 95% by 2047 from the current 32%



It also aims to enhance the modal share of coastal shipping and inland waterway transport from 109 MTPA in FY22 to 500 MTPA by 2047